

WASTE COLLECTION SYSTEM

Weightlessness in space makes going to the toilet very difficult. Space toilets work like a vacuum cleaner, using suction to pull waste away from your body and into a waste tank. Astronauts of both sexes use a hose to collect urine; otherwise they sit down on the toilet.

Waste tank can recycle urine into drinking water

POTABLE AND WASTE TANK

CH2 PRESSURE

Thigh bars prevent the astronaut from floating off the seat

The urine collected on Apollo and Gemini craft was dumped into space.

Handle for the vacuum pump that flushes the toilet

DATA FILE



FIRST USED: 1967 (Soyuz)



SPACE AGENCIES: Russian space program and NASA